per month? Is this likely to change over time, and, if so, how quickly? Viable implementations of this capability could range from a manual SQL insert performed by a system administrator to a fully automated web interface where property owners sign up and create their own accounts with no manual intervention. Until the business goals were clearly defined, they had no way of knowing. These requirements were also quite low-level, and gave no context or background as to why they might want to add a new property manager or send property owners notifications, for example.

As we discussed earlier, this "shopping-list" style of requirements doesn't lend itself well to understanding why a particular feature is needed and makes it hard to adapt to change when your understanding of the true business needs evolves, when new requirements emerge, or when technical or nontechnical issues force you to change your tack.

To rectify this, the real estate development team tried to determine what it was that the application was trying to achieve. After popping the why stack a few times, they managed to identify the following core business goal:

```
Goal: Win more management contracts by providing better service to property
     owners
In order to win more management contracts
As a property manager
I want to be able to provide better service to property owners
```

Supporting this goal, they came up with a set of high-level capabilities that included the following:

```
Capability: Notify the property owner at promised times
In order to provide property owner-specific notification schedules
As a property manager
I want the property owner to be able to set their preferred notification
     schedule
```

```
Capability: To have peace of mind regarding managed properties
In order to provide property owners easy access to their statements
As a property owner
I want to be able to access vital statistics about my managed properties at
     any time
```

```
Capability: To ensure that I pay the promised recurring expenses
In order to manage recurring expenses
As a property manager
I want the payments to be done automatically or be reminded about them if I
     need to intervene
```

Not all capabilities are focused on business functionality. Some, such as security and performance, can apply across the whole system. For example, they were able to define the following security capability:

```
Capability: To keep confidential information safe
In order to ensure that my customer information is only available to my
     employees
As a property manager
I want client data to be only transmitted over a secured connection
```